

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | CISSP

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience delivering enterprise-grade security across complex, multi-site environments. I bring proven expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, and Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (AD)), including Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and identity governance. I have hands-on experience with Windows Server infrastructure including Active Directory (AD), Group Policy, DNS, and DHCP, and I have managed security certificate lifecycles using Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) principles. I specialise in incident response and threat monitoring using Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms and Kusto Query Language (KQL), vulnerability management, and security architecture across hybrid cloud and on-premises environments. I take ownership of security controls end-to-end and communicate complex technical findings clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders. I am ready to bring this expertise to a demanding, fast-paced organisation such as a global law firm.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, alert triage, detection engineering, automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender -- 8,000-user deployment
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Azure AD, Group Policy, identity governance
- **Windows Infrastructure Security:** Active Directory (AD), DNS, DHCP, Windows Server hardening, Group Policy Object (GPO) management
- **Certificate and PKI Management:** Security certificate lifecycle management, renewal processes, certificate hygiene
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)), Tanium
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Incident Response:** National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK Framework, digital forensics, containment and remediation
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, security automation, workflow integration
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 -- Present*

- Own and manage the Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, configuring policies, investigating alerts, and driving threat monitoring and incident response activities.
- Administer Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, authoring KQL detection rules, tuning alert logic, and building SOAR playbooks to automate security responses and reduce mean time to respond

(MTTR).

- Manage Microsoft Entra ID including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and identity governance, ensuring zero-trust access controls across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Administer Windows Server infrastructure security including Active Directory, Group Policy, DNS, and DHCP, hardening configurations and enforcing security baselines.
- Manage security certificate lifecycles including PKI-aligned processes for certificate provisioning, renewal, and retirement to maintain certificate hygiene across the environment.
- Administer Microsoft Intune for MDM and MAM, enforcing device compliance policies and securing mobile applications across the organisation.
- Manage BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access across critical systems and provide full auditability of privileged sessions.
- Lead vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, triaging findings by criticality and tracking remediation of penetration test findings to closure.
- Lead incident response activities aligned to NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident reviews across the organisation.
- Deliver security awareness training to staff, improving security culture and reducing susceptibility to phishing and social engineering attacks.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft 365 Defender across the UAL estate, monitoring threat alerts, investigating detections, and supporting incident containment.
- Managed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, triaging security events, writing KQL queries for threat hunting, and maintaining dashboards for security operations visibility.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO controls to protect identities and manage access across cloud and hybrid environments.
- Supported Windows Active Directory and Group Policy administration, hardening user and machine configurations in line with CIS Controls benchmarks.
- Managed security certificate renewals and maintained certificate inventory, ensuring no expired certificates caused service disruption or security exposure.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, reporting risk to leadership and driving remediation activities across infrastructure and application teams.
- Supported incident response operations, performing log analysis, digital forensics, and threat correlation to investigate and close security events.
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, managing privileged accounts and mobile device compliance.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Administered security controls and Windows infrastructure including Active Directory, Group Policy, and endpoint protection tools, ensuring hardened configurations across the SaaS environment.
- Supported vulnerability identification and remediation processes, patching and hardening systems to reduce risk exposure.
- Managed identity and access management including user provisioning, deprovisioning, and role-based access control (RBAC) across cloud and on-premises platforms.
- Provided security input into infrastructure projects, applying security-by-design principles and supporting compliance requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users at UAL, achieving comprehensive threat monitoring coverage and reducing detection gaps.
- Built and tuned a library of KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving alert fidelity and reducing false positives for the security operations function.
- Designed and implemented Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and identity governance policies, eliminating legacy access pathways and strengthening zero-trust access controls.

- Led security certificate lifecycle management across UAL, establishing a systematic renewal process that eliminated certificate expiry incidents.
- Delivered BeyondTrust PAM enterprise-wide, achieving full privileged access visibility and control across critical systems.
- Established NIST 800-61-aligned incident response processes, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for security events organisation-wide.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)